ZHONG HUA SHI FU · CHINESE BISTRO · 食 BISTRO

中华食付

FOUR SEASONS

MENU

A table of small poems.

Every grain has a story;
every bite, a kindred spirit.

壹 COLD *the overture*

● 梅子黄时
Plum Rain
SOUR-PLUM TOMATOES

Peeled tomatoes steeped overnight in chilled sour-plum syrup. Tart, then sweet, like *a soft rain in Jiangnan*.

● 锦官卤韵
Echoes of Chengdu
SICHUAN COLD PLATTER

Tripe, chicken feet, gizzards, radish and tofu, steeped in a red master stock. *Numbing, fiery, fragrant.*

● 青麻踏浪
Pepper on the Waves
PEPPERCORN PRAWNS

Ice-chilled prawns under crushed green peppercorn and sizzling oil — *a light tingle*, a clean sweetness.

贰 HOT *the main chapter*

● 春山拾翠
Spring Hills in Green
MORELS & ASPARAGUS

Honeycomb morels that hold every drop of sauce, asparagus crisp as young bamboo — *a plate of mountain spring*.

● 文火流年
Slow Fire, Passing Years
SLOW-BRAISED BEEF · PEARL BARLEY

Beef braised low and slow until it *yields to the chopsticks*, over pearl barley that drinks in every drop.

● 听取蛙声
Listening to the Frogs
BULLFROG · PURPLE PERILLA

"Amid rice blossoms, the frogs sing of harvest." Tender wok-fried bullfrog, *wild with peppery perilla*.

● 但爱鲈鱼
For the Love of Sea Bass
SEA BASS · FIRE-ROASTED CHILI

"All who travel the river love the sea bass." Silken fish under blistered green chili — *smoky, spicy, honest*.

● 黔火宫灯
Lanterns & Mountain Fire
KUNG PAO PRAWNS · GUIZHOU CHILI

Golden prawns in a lychee-style *sweet-and-sour glaze* over smoky Guizhou toasted chili. Half palace, half mountain.

● 炭火南风
Charcoal & Southern Wind
BEEF & PINEAPPLE SKEWERS

Threaded together and kissed by charcoal; the fruit's bright tang melts the richness — *a warm tropical breeze*.

● 茅香雪花
Lemongrass & Snowflakes
LEMONGRASS PORK JOWL

A prized cut, marbled like falling snow. Lemongrass-marinated and grilled — *crisp, juicy*, softly citrus.

● 金甲卧云
Golden Armor on a Cloud
CRISPY CHICKEN · CORN-POTATO PURÉE

Golden, crackling skin on a cloud of sweet corn and potato purée. *Crisp outside, tender within*.

叁 SWEET *the coda*

● 围炉夜话
Fireside Tales
SWEET POTATO PUDDING

Sweet potato whipped with egg and cream, then baked. Melting and gently sweet — *the warmth of a winter fire*.

Snow is coming tonight —
shall we share a cup?

— Bai Juyi, *To Liu Shijiu*